

Daily Payments & Fintech Intelligence Brief

May 13, 2026

1. TOP PAYMENTS HEADLINES

1. PSD3 / PSR Final Texts Published — EU Parliament Plenary Vote Imminent

What happened:

On April 23, 2026, the Council of the European Union published the final compromise texts for the Third Payment Services Directive (PSD3) and the new Payment Services Regulation (PSR). The ECON Committee voted on May 5; a Parliament plenary vote is expected in late May, with Official Journal publication targeted for June/July 2026 (possibly slipping to September). The rules will apply 21 months post-publication — placing full implementation in late 2027 or early 2028.

Why it matters:

- PSD3 and PSR split PSD2's monolithic scope: PSD3 governs authorisation, governance, capital, and supervision of payment institutions; PSR directly regulates payment conduct — applying without national transposition, enabling faster and more uniform EU-wide regulatory effect.
- The PSR's direct applicability is the architectural shift: unlike PSD2, there is no transposition ambiguity by member state — timelines and obligations are uniform from day one.
- Non-EU PSPs serving EU markets, and all EU-licensed PSPs, should begin PSD3/PSR readiness assessments now — the 21-month window starts on Official Journal publication, not when national laws are enacted.
- Open banking provisions in PSD3 strengthen ASPSP data-sharing obligations and introduce a new 'payment service data scheme' concept — material implications for A2A payment product and open finance infrastructure strategy.

Regulation / Open Finance /
Market Structure

New today

Region: European Union

Players: European Parliament, Council of the EU, European Commission, banks, PSPs, fintechs

2. GENIUS Act: FDIC and OCC Run Concurrent NPRMs — Comment Period Closes June 9

What happened:

Two parallel U.S. stablecoin rulemakings are in the comment phase simultaneously. The OCC published its GENIUS Act NPRM on March 2, 2026; the FDIC approved its NPRM on April 7, 2026 (Federal Register, April 10; comment deadline June 9). Both agencies propose: 2-business-day redemption requirements for Permitted Payment Stablecoin Issuers (PPSIs), reserve asset standards, capital requirements, and risk management frameworks. The GENIUS Act's 18-month outer limit from enactment (July 18, 2025) sets a January 2027 floor for the effective date — or 120 days post-final-rules, whichever comes first.

Why it matters:

- Two concurrent NPRMs from the FDIC and OCC define the institutional architecture for U.S. stablecoin payment rails — who can issue, how reserves are structured, and what redemption UX is legally permissible.
- The 2-business-day redemption requirement has direct implications for stablecoin payment liquidity design — it limits atomic settlement propositions currently marketed by crypto-native issuers.
- Non-bank issuers face a structural disadvantage: the GENIUS Act's framework favors FDIC- and OCC-supervised entities — reshaping competition between bank-issued and non-bank-issued stablecoins as payment instruments.
- The June 9 comment deadline is the clearest opportunity for PSPs, banks, and payments infrastructure firms to shape the final US stablecoin payment framework.

Stablecoins / Regulation /
Market Structure

Follow-up with material update

Region: United States

Players: FDIC, OCC, Federal Reserve, Treasury,
stablecoin issuers, banks, PSPs

3. FSB Launches Cross-Border Payments Public-Private Implementation Phase — G20 Targets at Risk

What happened:

In March 2026, the FSB convened its Cross-Border Payments Summit in London, launching a new structured public-private implementation phase under the G20 Roadmap. The Institute of International Finance (IIF) committed to producing industry findings and recommendations in H2 2026. FSB data shows G20 Roadmap KPIs for 2025 achieved only marginal improvement since 2023, with the 2027 targets — sub-1% retail cross-border cost, 75% of payments in under 1 hour, expanded access — now considered unlikely to be met on schedule.

Why it matters:

- The official acknowledgment that 2027 Roadmap targets are at risk is a material policy signal — it opens a window for recalibrating targets and reprioritising interventions, with the IIF report becoming the primary industry voice in that process.
- The shift to public-private co-design changes how PSPs should engage: active participation in IIF workstreams and FSB consultation processes now offers greater leverage over framework design than waiting for final rules.
- FX markup transparency, access for underserved corridors, and data interoperability remain the persistent bottlenecks — the same gaps that existed when the Roadmap launched in 2020.
- ISO 20022 adoption by RTGS systems is projected to reach 83% by end-2026 (BIS CPMI), overtaking fast-payment-system adoption for the first time — a technical milestone the Roadmap depends on but does not alone resolve.

Cross-Border / Market Structure
/ Regulation

Escalation — G20 targets
officially at risk

Region: Global

Players: FSB, BIS, G20, IIF, central banks, global
PSPs, correspondent banks

4. ISO 2022 RTGS Adoption Reaches Structural Tipping Point — November Structured Address Deadline in Focus

What happened:

BIS CPMI data confirms ISO 2022 adoption by RTGS systems is on track to surpass 83% by end-2026, overtaking fast-payment systems and representing the first time the standard becomes functionally dominant across high-value settlement infrastructure. Simultaneously, SWIFT's November 2026 CBPR+ deadline for fully structured postal address fields — mandatory structured country code and town name minimum — is the most pressing near-term compliance horizon for cross-border payment institutions. SEPA version 3.7 (pain.001.001.09 and pain.008.001.08) is mandatory now, cascading into payment factory and ERP/TMS format dependencies.

Why it matters:

- 83% RTGS adoption is not a migration milestone — it is the point at which ISO 2022 becomes the default expectation of global high-value settlement, making non-compliance a competitive and operational liability rather than a timeline risk.
- Institutions with unstructured legacy address data face SWIFT surcharges (active since January 1, 2026) and a hard exclusion risk from November 2026 — data remediation programs must be operating at scale now, not scoped.
- Fully structured ISO 2022 data unlocks compounding returns: enhanced ML-based fraud detection, higher-confidence sanctions screening, and straight-through processing rates that reduce manual intervention costs.
- SEPA 3.7 format changes cascade into corporate payment factory integrations, ERP/TMS configurations, and bank-to-corporate API schemas — product and operations teams must validate end-to-end format compliance now.

Infrastructure / Regulation

Follow-up with material update

Region: Global / Europe

Players: SWIFT, SEPA operators, BIS CPMI, corporate treasuries, TMS/ERP vendors, correspondent banks

5. MAS Launches Project BLOOM — Tokenized Settlement Assets and Agentic Payments

What happened:

The Monetary Authority of Singapore launched Project BLOOM (Borderless, Liquid, Open, Online, Multi-currency), a structured financial industry collaboration exploring tokenized bank liabilities and well-regulated stablecoins as settlement assets for cross-border payments. BLOOM's three initial workstreams are: (1) distribution and clearing of tokenized settlement assets, (2) programmable compliance controls for automated AML/KYC, and (3) agentic payments — fully AI-initiated, automated payment flows. MAS will also trial tokenized government bills in 2026, settled using wholesale central bank digital currency (wCBDC).

Why it matters:

- Project BLOOM is MAS's first structured, multi-firm program specifically targeting tokenized settlement infrastructure — moving from sandboxed experimentation to industry-scale design of production-grade payment architecture.
- Agentic payments represent a genuinely new product category: AI agents initiating transactions autonomously require new authorization frameworks, liability models, real-time spending controls, and audit trails — none of which current payment schemes are designed for.
- Tokenized bank liabilities as settlement assets could eliminate pre-funding and trapped nostro/vostro liquidity in cross-border corridors — a structural cost reduction that benefits both PSPs and their corporate clients.
- Singapore's simultaneous operation of Project Nexus (multilateral IPS linkage), BLOOM (tokenized settlement), and wCBDC trials positions MAS as the most comprehensive testing ground for next-generation payment infrastructure globally.

Infrastructure / RTP / Open
Finance / Stablecoins

New today

Region: Singapore / Global

Players: MAS, financial industry participants, stablecoin issuers, banks, technology providers

2. MAJOR FINTECH HEADLINES

1. Adyen Acquires Talon.One for €750 Million — Merchant Value Stack Expands Beyond Payments

What happened:

Adyen has signed a definitive agreement to acquire Talon.One, a Berlin-based enterprise-grade provider of loyalty, promotion, and referral management software, for €750 million. The transaction is expected to close in H2 2026. Talon.One serves major enterprise merchants managing complex multi-channel loyalty and discount programs across digital and physical commerce environments.

Why it matters to fintech / payments:

Adyen is making a deliberate move from payment processor to merchant operating system. By combining real-time transaction data at the authorization layer with loyalty and promotion management, Adyen gains the ability to offer merchants real-time promotion triggers, customer lifetime value analytics, and dynamic incentive personalization at point-of-sale — creating a closed-loop data and payments offering that neither pure loyalty platforms nor pure processors currently provide at scale. This competes directly with Stripe's merchant-side product stack and intensifies the battle for enterprise merchant platform ownership.

Strategic relevance:

Payment processors are racing to own the merchant value stack beyond the authorization moment — loyalty, data, and engagement infrastructure are the next competitive frontier.

2. Ebury Raises £550 Million — Santander Doubles Down on B2B Cross-Border Payments

What happened:

UK fintech Ebury, specialising in cross-border payments, FX risk management, and trade finance for SMEs and mid-market corporates, raised approximately £550 million in new funding. Majority shareholder Santander increased its stake in the round, which was led by new investor Centerbridge Partners alongside Vitruvian Partners and 83North. The raise positions Ebury to accelerate geographic expansion and deepen its payments and lending product set.

Why it matters to fintech / payments:

A £550 million raise for a B2B cross-border payments fintech, in an environment where European fintech funding is down approximately 60%, is a significant outlier. It signals sustained institutional conviction in the underserved SME cross-border payments segment — a market where bank offerings remain expensive, opaque, and slow. Santander's increased stake deepens the bank-fintech co-ownership model and creates a strategic distribution advantage across Santander's global banking footprint, particularly in the UK, Spain, and Latin America. Combined with Ebury's FX and trade finance capabilities, this positions it as a serious platform competitor to traditional correspondent banking for mid-market cross-border flows.

Strategic relevance:

B2B cross-border payments for SMEs remains a high-conviction category — even in a tighter funding environment — with bank-fintech co-ownership emerging as the dominant scaling model.

3. European Fintech Funding Down 60% — Infrastructure Layer Outperforms Consumer Neobanks

What happened:

European fintech funding has fallen approximately 60% from peak levels, with the neobank wave stratifying sharply into three tiers: pan-European leaders running licensed banks (Revolut, N26, Monzo, Bunq), a mid-tier of profitable vertical challengers, and a significant wave of failures among mid-sized neobanks that exhausted runway after cheap capital dried up. Meanwhile, embedded finance infrastructure — payments APIs, compliance-as-a-service, embedded lending — is capturing disproportionate value, with the global embedded finance market reaching approximately \$197 billion in 2026 (31% CAGR through 2034).

Why it matters to fintech / payments:

The stratification of European fintech reflects a market structure shift: the consumer distribution layer is consolidating toward a few scaled winners, while infrastructure and API-layer players are growing faster and capturing more durable margin. For payments product leaders, this means the strategic value of orchestration platforms, compliance APIs, and embedded payment infrastructure has increased — and the risk of over-indexing on consumer distribution without infrastructure differentiation has become clear.

Strategic relevance:

Infrastructure-first fintech is outcompeting consumer distribution as the primary value-capture layer — the margin pool is moving to the platform, not the product.

3. WHAT MATTERS MOST

■ Regulation is converging simultaneously across all major payment hubs — on both ends of the stack.

PSD3/PSR, GENIUS Act NPRMs, and MAS BLOOM are all reaching decision points in the same narrow window. Organisations operating across US, EU, and Singapore jurisdictions face a multi-front compliance and product re-architecture calendar through 2027. The regulatory scaffolding being installed now — stablecoin issuance rules, PSR conduct obligations, tokenized settlement frameworks — will define the competitive operating environment for the next decade.

■ Tokenized settlement infrastructure is moving from policy aspiration to institutional program.

MAS BLOOM represents the clearest signal yet that central banks and regulated institutions are actively designing — not just studying — tokenized settlement for cross-border payments. Combined with Singapore's wCBDC trials, the GENIUS Act's stablecoin payment framework, and the FSB's public-private implementation phase, the conditions for a meaningful tokenized payment layer are coalescing across multiple jurisdictions simultaneously. The question is no longer if, but which architecture wins — and who the intermediaries are.

■ The G20 cross-border payments ambition is formally behind schedule — creating both risk and opportunity.

With 2027 G20 Roadmap KPIs acknowledged as unlikely to be met, the FSB and IIF are entering a period of Roadmap revision. This creates a genuine lobbying and agenda-setting opportunity for payment infrastructure players who can demonstrate credible corridor-level impact. It also signals that the correspondent banking model, despite ISO 20022 uplift, is not delivering the speed, cost, and transparency improvements that the Roadmap promised — keeping pressure on multilateral alternatives like Project Nexus.

4. IMPLICATIONS FOR A PAYMENTS PRODUCT LEADER

1. Engage the GENIUS Act comment process before June 9.

The FDIC's 2-business-day redemption requirement and reserve asset framework will define US stablecoin payment UX, liquidity management, and competitive structure. For any organisation building or planning stablecoin payment capabilities in the US market, the comment window is the highest-leverage moment to shape the final framework — not just observe it. Particular attention should go to the redemption timeline, reserve asset eligibility, and interoperability obligations.

2. Launch a PSD3 / PSR readiness program with a late-2027 target date.

The 21-month implementation window starts on Official Journal publication (estimated June/July 2026). For EU-market participants, the PSR's direct applicability means obligations will be uniform and immediate — no transposition gaps. Two parallel workstreams are needed: (a) PSR conduct compliance and open banking data-sharing obligations; (b) PSD3 authorisation, capital, and governance alignment by jurisdiction. Begin scope assessment now — late readiness programs in mid-2027 will face regulatory and resourcing constraints.

3. Define your agentic payments policy before regulators define it for you.

MAS BLOOM's explicit agentic payments workstream is an early signal that regulators are beginning to engage with AI-initiated payment flows. Payments product leaders should define internal frameworks now: what authorization levels can AI agents hold? What real-time spending controls apply? Who bears liability for erroneous agent-initiated transactions? Organisations that publish internal agentic payment governance policies in 2026 will be better positioned to participate in regulatory design processes — and to win institutional client trust when agentic payment products launch.

5. OPTIONAL WATCHLIST — Watch Next

● IIF Cross-Border Payments Recommendations Report — H2 2026.

The IIF has committed to producing industry findings and recommendations for evolving the G20 Roadmap framework. This document will be the primary industry voice in the next phase of cross-border payment reform design. Payments organisations should engage the IIF working process now and monitor the draft for corridor prioritisation, technology recommendations, and governance proposals that could become the basis for FSB's revised Roadmap targets.

● GENIUS Act Final Rules — Effective Date Window (120 days post-final-rules or January 2027).

The FDIC comment period closes June 9 and OCC's on a similar timeline. Watch for final rule publication in Q3/Q4 2026 — which triggers the 120-day clock for the GENIUS Act's effective date. This is the hard deadline for stablecoin payment issuers to be licensed, reserves to be structured, and redemption mechanisms to be in production. Banks and PSPs planning stablecoin payment products must have implementation programs running before final rules publish.

● EU PSD3/PSR Official Journal Publication — June/July 2026 (potentially September).

The timing of Official Journal publication directly sets the 21-month implementation clock. A September publication pushes full PSR applicability to mid-2028, while a June publication targets late 2027. Both timelines are close enough that readiness programs should run to the earlier scenario. Watch for Parliament plenary vote outcome and legal-linguistic review timeline to determine which publication date is realistic.

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